



reviewers. The phone comes with Android 14 with Realme UI 5.0 on top and it features 65 percent fewer preinstalled third-party apps. This immediately makes the phone feel much cleaner. The UI is the same as before, and it does look clunkier than say a Nothing Phone's UI, but the experience has improved. Now, all that needs to improve is the software update policy which is stuck at 2 (OS updates) + 3 (security updates) years.

The phone brings a ton of innovative features to the table though. There's Air Gestures that lets you navigate the phone hands-free which worked surprisingly well in my testing. The phone also comes with Rainwater Touch, dual carrier aggregation support, Flash Capsule (realme's take on Dynamic Island) and File Dock.

CAMERAS

Cameras are a huge focus of Realme phones, and the same is true for the Realme Narzo 70 Pro. While the secondary 8 MP ultrawide shooter and tertiary 2 MP lens are nothing to write home about, Realme has incorporated the renowned Sony IMX890 primary camera which featured in flagship phones such as last year's OnePlus 11. The camera has an f/1.88 aperture and comes with OIS and 2x in-sensor

zoom. There's also a 16 MP front camera for selfies.

While most are well aware of the capabilities of the Sony IMX890 lens, the Realme Narzo 70 Pro's results are quite a mixed bag. For instance, you can get some stunning shots in ideal lighting – the dynamic range is good and everything looks crisp. However, the colours, while flattering are a bit too contrasty.

Another issue is portraits – the results were just mediocre, in my opinion. The detail retention is good, but the edge detection is quite poor. Additionally, even though the 1x and 2x portrait shots both use the same camera, there's a massive colour profile difference which is obvious when you compare the skin tone on these pictures. Check the samples below that were taken consecutively but have completely different colour science, particularly when representing skin.

Low light was also an issue. Once again, the details are solid – everything looks super crisp. However, there's way too much lens flare in nearly every low-light picture.

So, while Realme has incorporated a fantastic sensor for the price, there's a lack of polish that's really quite apparent upon some inspection.

BATTERY LIFE

The Realme Narzo 70 Pro houses a 5,000 mAh battery, which is standard affair at this point. The phone boasts 67 W SUPERVOOC fast charging as well. So, both the battery capacity and charging speeds remain unchanged as compared to the predecessor. The phone even houses the same processor as its predecessor, so battery life is quite similar.

The phone can easily last a day even with heavy usage which includes playing games, clicking pictures and shooting videos. In our 4K video loop test, the Realme Narzo 70 Pro lasted nearly 14 hours from full charge to empty. Additionally, the phone charges quite fast – 58 minutes from zero to full.

VERDICT

The Realme Narzo 70 Pro impresses with its premium design, crisp AMOLED display, versatile features, and fast UFS 3.1 storage speeds, however, it lacks a certain level of polish. The camera, which is supposed to be the star of the phone, proved to be a bit too inconsistent for my liking. The disparity in the colour science of portraits taken at different magnification levels can be jarring, and low-light performance is definitely not as strong as I'd like it to be.

The Nothing Phone (2a), especially with its latest software update, is much more reliable when it comes to the camera. For raw power, the cheaper iQOO Z9 knocks it out of the park. These alternatives could suit you better depending on your preferred use cases.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 7050 | GPU: Mali-G68 | RAM: 8 GB LPDDR4X | Storage: 128/256 GB UFS 3.1 | Cooling: 4356.52 mm² stainless steel VC | OS: Android 14, Realme UI 5.0 | Cameras: 50 MP Sony IMX890 + 8 MP + 2 MP | Selfie camera: 16 MP | Display: 6.67" AMOLED FHD+ | Display brightness: 2000 nits local peak brightness | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 67 W SUPERVOOC | Weight: 195 g | Colours: Glass Green, Glass Gold

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